

Northern skies

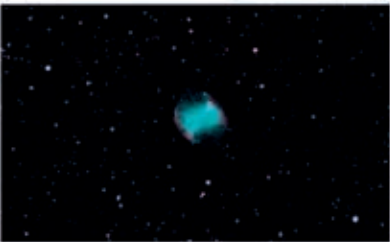
If you live north of the equator, you live in the northern hemisphere. On a dark and cloudless night, you can see a mass of glittering stars. If you know what to look for, you can pick out individual stars, constellations, and other wonders of the night sky.

THE NAMES FOR MOST OF THE CONSTELLATIONS IN THE NORTHERN SKIES COME FROM THE ANCIENT GREEKS

KEY This map shows stars that are visible to the naked eye. Magnitude marks how bright a star is – the lower the number, the brighter the star.			
Yellow star	Red star	Magnitude brighter than 0.0	Magnitude brighter than 3.0
Orange star	White star	Magnitude brighter than 1.0	Magnitude brighter than 4.0
Blue star		Magnitude brighter than 2.0	Magnitude brighter than 5.0

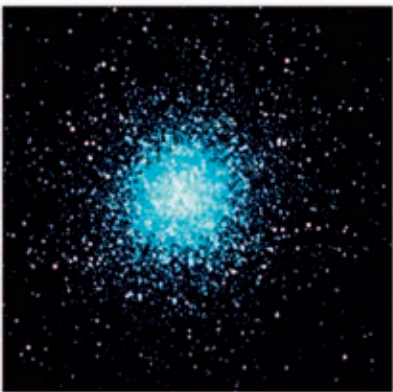
THINGS TO LOOK FOR

Individual stars, star clusters, and whole galaxies can be seen with binoculars or a small telescope. Here are some key sights to look out for in the northern skies.



DUMBBELL NEBULA

This is a planetary nebula, which means it is made up of clouds of material shed by a star. It is in the constellation of Vulpecula.



STAR CLUSTER M13

This is the finest globular (globe-shaped) cluster in the northern skies. It lies in the Hercules constellation.



HYADES STAR CLUSTER

This star cluster makes up the face of the bull in the constellation Taurus. The brightest star here is the giant star Aldebaran, which marks the eye of Taurus.



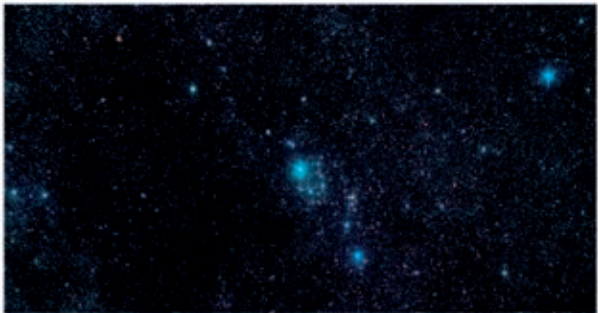
LEO CONSTELLATION

The constellation Leo contains three spiral galaxies: M65, M66, and NGC 3628. They are known as the Leo Triplet.



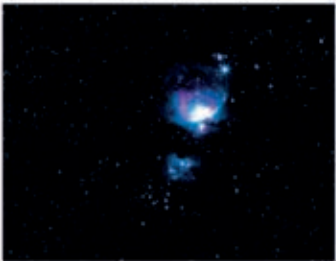
PLEIADES STAR CLUSTER

This cluster in Taurus is also known as the Seven Sisters, because seven of its blue stars are visible to the naked eye.



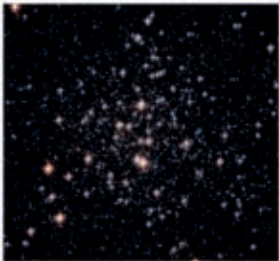
PERSEUS CONSTELLATION

This constellation is best known for its yearly Perseid meteor shower, which takes place in mid-August. It lies just below the "W" shape of the constellation of Cassiopeia.



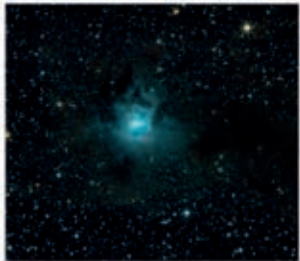
ORION NEBULA

This nebula marks the position of the "sword" below the "belt" of Orion in the Orion constellation.



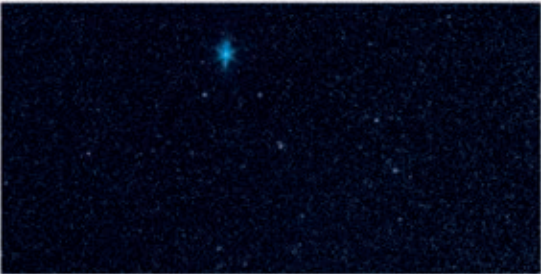
M71 STAR CLUSTER

This loosely packed star cluster is on the edge of our galaxy. It sits in the Sagitta constellation.



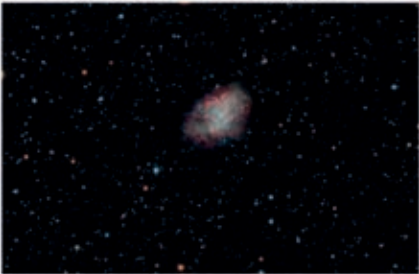
REFLECTION NEBULA

This ghostly blue nebula is in the constellation of Cepheus. At its heart is a cluster of stars.



LYRA CONSTELLATION

The small constellation Lyra has one brilliant star, Vega. It is the fifth-brightest of all the stars.



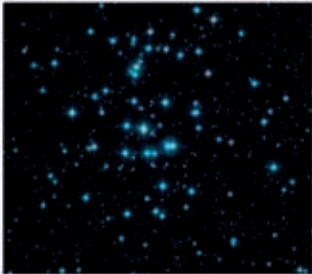
CRAB NEBULA

This is the remains of a supernova (an exploding star). It is found in Taurus, near the southerly "bull horn".



M15 STAR CLUSTER

This globular cluster is in Pegasus, northwest of Epsilon Pegasi, the constellation's brightest star.



BEEHIVE CLUSTER

This swarm of stars in the constellation of Cancer is about three times the diameter of the Moon.

